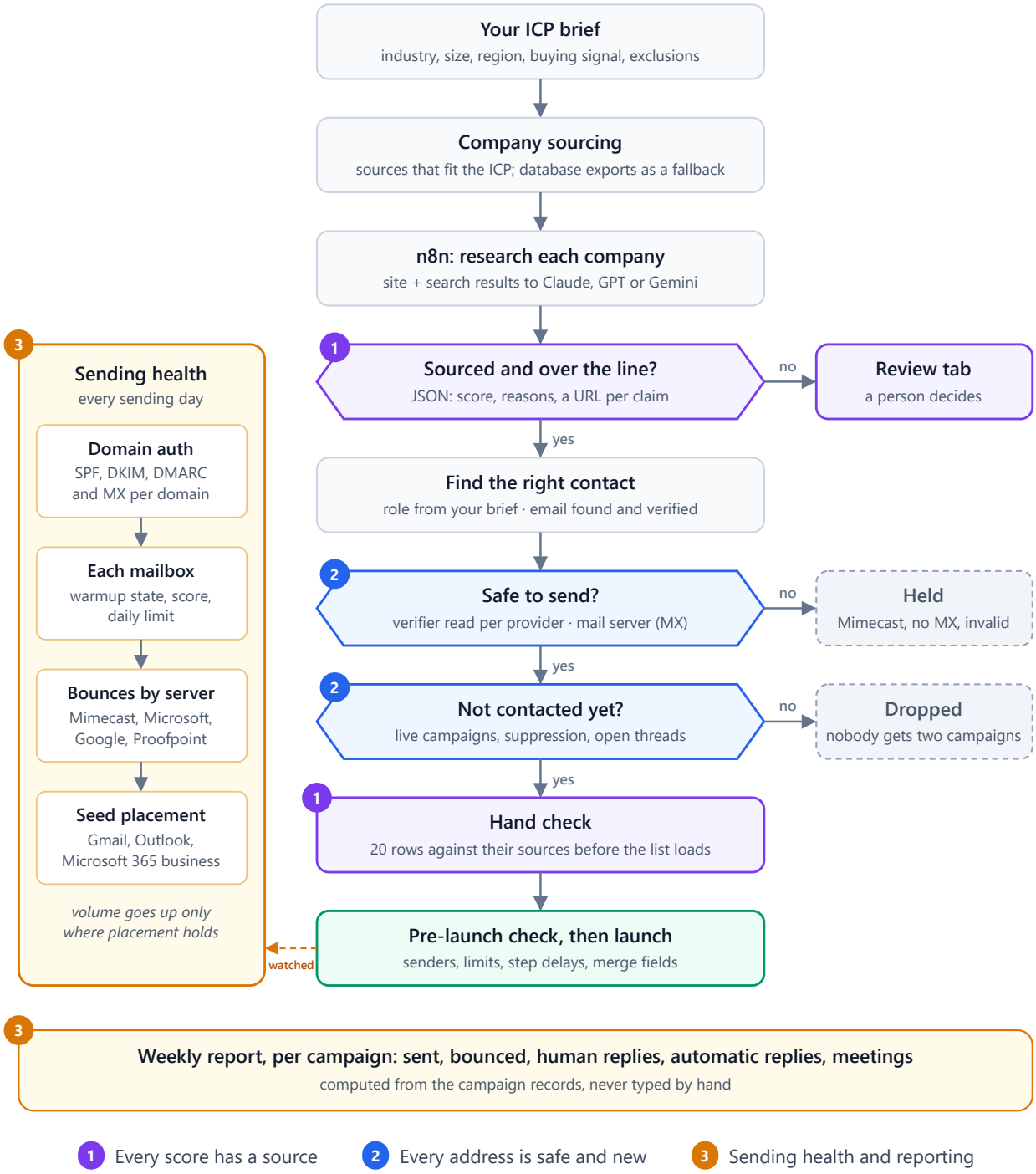
From ICP brief to launched campaign, with a check at each place a list usually goes wrong

Prepared for Assivo · Matthias, UnpauseAI · 4 November 2026

The four ICP lists each week run through one n8n workflow. The model does the company research; nothing reaches Instantly without a source behind its score, an address that is safe to send to, and a dedupe against every live campaign. The senders are watched every day the lists are sending.



1 Every score has a source

- The model gets your ICP brief, the company's site and search results, and returns JSON: a fit score, the reasons, and a source URL for each claim.
- Output that fails the schema, cites nothing, or scores under the line goes to a review tab, not the list.
- Before a list loads, 20 rows are checked by hand against their sources. Where my read and the model's disagree, the prompt changes before the list ships.

2 Every address is safe and new

- A verifier checks that a mailbox exists, not that its mail server accepts cold mail. NeverBounce-valid addresses behind Mimecast bounced 10 times in 11 sends; behind Microsoft, once in 80.
- The reverse holds too: "unknown" on Hotmail, iCloud and NHS is the server refusing the probe. All 335 such addresses we could check had already received mail, so they stay.
- Each domain's mail server is read at load; Mimecast and no-MX addresses are held. Dedupe runs against every live campaign, the suppression list and open threads.

Week 1: the audit

Check	What it catches
SPF, DKIM, DMARC and MX on every sending domain	Domains that can't authenticate or receive replies. In one audit of 53 purchased domains, none had MX records and 3 had SPF and DKIM.
Warmup, daily limit and bounces per mailbox, grouped by recipient mail server	Senders that dropped out of the warmup pool (three mailboxes on a domain missing from DNS), and gateway blocks a list verifier can't see.
Seed-inbox placement on Gmail, Outlook and Microsoft 365 business	Inbox or spam per provider, before volume goes up.
Step delays and merge fields in every live sequence	Instantly puts the delay on the earlier step; a 0 there sends the follow-up minutes after the first email.
Report figures recomputed from the campaign records	Hand-typed numbers. One report said 34 people in conversation; the database said 40.

Four weeks, against the posted milestones

Week	Deliverability ($80)	Data operations ($120)
1	Audit and findings list, fixes in order	Research workflow built on your first ICP briefs; the week's lists go through it
2	Fixes applied, seed tests repeated, daily sender checks	Four ICP lists through the workflow
3	Pre-launch check on every campaign; volume up only where placement holds	Four lists; scoring adjusted from week 2's replies
4	Monitoring and a written runbook for the ongoing weeks	Four lists; workflow documented for the ongoing weeks
	Total, fixed price	**$800**

Built before (charts in the attached outbound-case-study.pdf)

- **UK events company, Instantly since May:** three sending domains on Google Workspace. Corporate bounce rate went 8.6%, then 1.5%, then 0% over three waves; a 773-person re-engagement bounced 0.6%.
- **Treasury-software company:** a lead desk that replaced nine scattered sources, each contact's stage computed from an event log and a daily mailbox scan. Conference follow-up: 127 reached, 40 in conversation, 20 meetings booked.
- **Finance team:** Gemini and OpenAI in a production receipt pipeline. The model proposes, a person confirms, and nothing it guessed reaches the books.